explain further. In this meeting she realised there were different funds available within her super, with different companies in them. Dr King also found out that out of the top five companies her retirement money was investing in, four of them were tobacco companies.

Let that last sentence just simmer for a moment. An oncologist, who spends every day of her job treating people for cancer, was unwittingly investing in one of the most common carcinogens in the world: tobacco. She owned a part in four tobacco companies! You can only imagine the shock and disgust she felt.

Most people would have just changed their fund and moved to another super, but Bronwyn went further. She wasn’t okay with the lack of transparency around investments. She realised it was a worldwide issue and created an organisation, Tobacco Free Portfolios, that creates policies in Australia and in over 20 countries worldwide to reduce tobacco investing options, and to encourage more transparency around ethical investing.

Investing and having a moral compass can sometimes seem like they don’t mix, but things have changed since 2010. In fact, investments in sustainable funds (which we’ll get into shortly) more than doubled in recent years. And in the US alone, over $17 trillion is under management using sustainable investing strategies. So, what are ethical investing, impact investing and socially responsible investing? Aren’t they all the same thing? And how does one become an ethical investor?

Ethical investing

Ethical investing means investing in companies and funds based on your own values and morals. What may be ethical to you may not be ethical to someone else, and that’s okay.

Ethical investing takes into account your religious, cultural, social and moral beliefs. It’s very much like conscious consumer culture. In the same way that you’d rather buy a tote bag from a brand that you know pays fair wages, investors in training would rather invest in an ethical company over one that doesn’t align with their values.